

Chapter-8

The Adverb

Read the following sentences carefully with special focus on the function of the italicised words.

1. The old woman walked *slowly*. (modifies the verb 'walked')
2. My mother is *very* beautiful. (modifies the adjective 'beautiful')
3. He could see the ship *quite* clearly. (modifies the adverb 'clearly')

Adverb: The word that modifies or adds to the meaning of a verb, an adjective or another adverb is called an adverb

Types of Adverbs

1. Adverb of Time

An adverb of time denotes the time of the action or verb in a sentence. It answers the question 'when'.

Examples: soon, early, late, yesterday, today, still, tomorrow, ago, already, just, before etc.

- ⇒ They haven't seen a zoo before.
- ⇒ You can go home now.
- ⇒ She is leaving for Delhi tomorrow.

2. Adverb of Place

An adverb of place denotes the place of the action or verb in a sentence. It answers the question 'where'.

Examples: above, up, below, down, far, near, within, without, away, out, outside, inside, in etc.

- ⇒ Don't sit here.
- ⇒ I will not go there.
- ⇒ He could not find his book anywhere

3. Adverb of Manner

An adverb of manner denotes the way or manner of the action or verb in a sentence. It answers the question 'how'.

Examples: fast, hurriedly, beautifully, speedily, correctly, rightly, boldly, madly etc.

- ⇒ Laxmibai fought bravely in the battle against the British.
- ⇒ A tortoise walks slowly.
- ⇒ He performed well at the function.

4. Adverb of Degree or Extent

An adverb of degree or extent denotes the extent or limit of the verb, adjective or some other adverb in a sentence. It answers the question 'how much or 'to what extent'.

Examples: too, very, extremely, almost, pretty, far, fairly, nearly, quite, enough, much, fully, partly, rather, so, little, much, too etc.

- ⇒ The apples are very sweet.
- ⇒ He is quite well now.
- ⇒ The work of construction of my house is almost complete now.

5. Adverb of Frequency or Number

An adverb of frequency or number denotes the number of times of the action or verb in a sentence. It answers the question 'how many times' or 'how often'.

Examples: once, twice, thrice, always, often, usually, seldom, firstly, secondly, frequently, again, sometimes, etc.

- ⇒ He called you up twice.
- ⇒ He has always supported me.
- ⇒ She is often in a bad mood.

6. Adverb of Affirmation or Negation

An adverb of affirmation denotes the positivity or certainty of the action or verb in a sentence.

Examples: yes, surely, definitely, certainly, of course, etc.

✧ He will definitely help you.

✧ She will surely submit the report tomorrow.

An Adverb of Negation denotes the negativity of the action/verb in a sentence.

Examples: not, never, hardly, rarely, scarcely, seldom

✧ He will not help you.

✧ She never comes late.

Exercise: Underline the adverbs in the following sentences and specify their type.

- | | |
|---|--|
| 1. I bought a new dress yesterday. | 9. My horse runs very fast. |
| 2. He understands me well. | 10. She decorated her house beautifully. |
| 3. The boys are playing outside. | 11. We must work hard. |
| 4. I go to library twice a week. | 12. You should drive carefully. |
| 5. They were extremely happy. | 13. Can you solve this sum? No, I can't. |
| 6. She is much better now. | 14. Always speak the truth. |
| 7. He is quite intelligent. | 15. They behaved badly with us. |
| 8. He will not come to school tomorrow. | 16. She often comes late. |

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with types of adverbs specified in the brackets.

1. Rohit went to the Raman's house(adverb of time)
2. The girls are(adverb of place)
3. A tortoise walks(adverb of manner)
4. He is cleverto see through your trick. (adverb of extent or degree)
5. Shegets angry. (adverb of negation)
6. Will you help me?, I will. (adverb of affirmation)
7. My mother goes to temple.....(adverb of frequency)
8. I looked for my lost book.....(adverb of place)
9. Einstein wasintelligent. (adverb of extent or degree)
10. We visited the Taj Mahal.....(adverb of time)

7. Interrogative Adverbs

The words 'when', 'where', 'how', 'why' are called interrogative adverbs as they are used to ask questions.

Examples:

- | | |
|---|--|
| 1. When are you going to Delhi? | 3. How did you solve the sum? |
| 2. Where have you kept my shoes? | 4. Why have you not taken your lunch? |

8. Relative Adverbs

When an interrogative adverb is used to join two clauses and refers to some antecedent in the principal clause, it is called relative adverb. Observe carefully how the following pair of sentences is joined using a relative adverb.

I know a company. He works there.

I know the company **where** he works.

Examples:

1. I don't know the time **when** he will return.
2. There must be some reason **why** he has left the job.
3. Can you show **how** this machine is operated?
4. My brother told me **how** the sum could be solved.

Exercise: Join the following pairs of sentences using the relative adverbs given in the brackets.

1. This is the house. I live here. (where)

.....

2. They shifted to their new house. She did not know the time. (when)

.....

3. You solved the sum. Tell me the way. (how)

.....

4. He was punished. No one knows the reason. (why)

.....

5. This is the office. She works here. (where)

.....

Forms of Adverbs

✦ Some adverbs and adjectives have the same form but are used differently.

Adjective	Adverb
She speaks in a loud voice.	Don't speak so loud.
He is a fast runner .	He runs fast.
They have much work to do.	She is not much interested in this job.
They work hard.	She is a hard worker.

✦ Some words may function as different types of adverbs.

He was sitting **far** from me. (Adverb of place)

My painting is **far** more beautiful than yours. (Adverb of degree)

✦ Some adverbs have two forms having different meanings.

She works very hard. (diligently)

She hardly works. (scarcely)

They found a hotel quite near. (not far away)

She was nearly unconscious. (almost)

Formation of Adverbs

Adverbs are formed in the following ways.

1. By adding '-ly' to various parts of speech

Examples: forcefully, cleverly, monthly, amazingly, hurriedly

Important Note: All the words that end in '-ly' are not essentially adverbs. For example: homely, elderly, worldly etc. are adjectives.

2. By adding prefixes or suffixes:

Examples: hereby, therewith, hitherto, thereafter, meanwhile, ahead, asleep, homeward, headlong, otherwise etc.

Exercise: Change the following adjectives in adverbs by make the required changes in the word given.

Adjective	Adverb	Adjective	Adverb	Adjective	Adverb
cold		casual		true	
happy		interesting		affectionate	
sad		careful		peaceful	
frequent		beautiful		scientific	
usual		deep		annual	
common		final		scientific	

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with the adverb form of the words given in the brackets.

- As I turned, Ihit her in the face. (accidental)
- Pt. Jawaharlal Nehru wascalled Chacha Nehru. (affectionate)
- And they all lived..... (happy) ever after.
- He spoke to me.....(angry)
- The exhibition is held(annual)
- The building is..... (central) air conditioned.
- It will.....rain today. (sure)
- They eat.....fruit and nut. (main)
- She has been behaving very.....(rude) lately.
- Thinking(positive) is a good way of dealing with stress.
- He answered the questions.....(quick)
- He is.....(powerful) built.
- She does her work.....(neat).
-(Natural), one gets upset when things go wrong.
- Can we find a(mutual) convenient time?

Comparison of Adverbs

Adverbs can be used to compare verbs, adjectives or adverbs. Like adjectives, adverbs too have three degrees of comparison: Positive, Comparative and Superlative. The three degrees of adverbs are formed in the following manners.

1. By adding ‘-er’ and ‘-est’ to the Positive Degree:

Positive Degree	Comparative Degree	Superlative Degree
near	nearer	nearest
late	later	latest

2. By adding ‘more’ and ‘most’ before the positive degree:

Positive Degree	Comparative Degree	Superlative Degree
beautifully	more beautifully	most beautifully
intelligently	more intelligently	most intelligently

3. In an irregular way:

Positive Degree	Comparative Degree	Superlative Degree
far	farther	farthest
forth	further	furthest
ill	worse	worst
badly	worse	worst
late	later	latest, last
much	more	most
near, nigh	nearer	nearest, next
well	better	best

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with correct degree of adverbs given in the bracket.

1. She decorated the roombeautifully than you. (much)
2.(near) the temple, (far) from God.
3. Our team performed.....than your team. (well)
4. Nodid the teacher enter the class than the students became silent. (soon)
5. Kerela isfrom Kashmir than Delhi. (far)
6. Picasso painted..... of all. (Well)
7. My sister camethan I came. (late)
8. She is much.....now. (well)
9. The hare ranthan the tortoise. (fast)
10. I work much.....than you do. (hard)

Transformation of Sentences by removing the adverb ‘too’

(I) If the adverb 'too' is followed by an adjective and then by a verb in the infinitive mood, the sentence is converted into a complex sentence with two clauses- the first clause containing 'so' and the second beginning with 'that'.

Example:

This trunk is too heavy for me to lift.

This trunk is so heavy that I cannot lift it.

He is too weak to walk.

He is so weak that he cannot walk.

(ii) If the original sentence contains no negative word, the subordinate clause becomes negative. If the sentence contains a negative word, the subordinate clause becomes positive. Example

1. He is too clever to be easily deceived. (positive)
He is so clever that he cannot be easily deceived. (Negative)
2. He is too confident not to face the interview. (Negative)
He is so confident that he will face the interview. (Positive)

(iii) If there is no infinitive after too, it can be replaced by the word more than enough, beyond the proper limit, over, excessively, very, extremely etc.

Examples:

- | | |
|-----------------------------|--|
| He is too eager for praise. | He is over eager for praise. |
| He is too intelligent. | He is very intelligent. |
| This city is too crowded. | This city is crowded beyond the limit. |

Transform the following sentences removing the adverb 'too'.

1. Riya is too fat to run fast.

2. The boy was too young to be sent out.

3. The class is too noisy.

4. The tiger was too old to jump.

5. It is too hot for us to go out.

6. The water in this river is too pure.

7. This news is too good to be true.

8. The rain is too heavy for me to go outside.

Transform the following sentences using 'too'.

1. The water in this river is pure beyond the proper limit.

2. It is so cold that we cannot go out.

3. Rama speaks so fast that she cannot be understood.

4. The lion was so weak that he could not attack the deer.

5. Mohan is so weak that he cannot walk.

6. This news is so good that it cannot be true.

7. He is so slow that he cannot win the race.

8. The question is so difficult that I cannot try it.